VOL. 1 · NO. 34 PRINTED FOR DANIEL PRICE: ONE CUP OF COFFEE

The Morning Newspaper

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2026 · AUSTIN EDITION

81° / 57° | Mostly clear, 0% rain, wind up to 7 mph | Tomorrow: 82° / 56°, overcast | Sunrise 7:36 · Sunset 18:54 | Waxing gibbous

France Widens Curfews After Worst Unrest in Years

Marseille braces for more disorder as the riots that began last weekend harden a rightward turn across European politics.

WORLD & TECH

France widens curfews after worst unrest in years

BBC · THE NEW YORK TIMES · THE GUARDIAN

French authorities extended nighttime curfews nationwide after a calm night followed days of rioting, with those arrested in the chaos facing expedited trials. Marseille braced for renewed disorder after weekend protests gave way to what the BBC called "apocalyptic" scenes, while the Times reported the unrest is accelerating a broader shift away from centrist politics across Europe.

TikTok executives ignored child-exploitation warnings, depositions show

NPR, VIA TECHMEME

Depositions reported by NPR found TikTok staff repeatedly raised internal concerns about minors appearing in sexually exploitative livestreams on the app's Live feature, warnings that executives allegedly brushed aside. The claims echo an earlier lawsuit accusing the company of knowing children bypassed Live's age limits and declining to intervene because of the revenue involved.

U.S. bars federal agencies from using China's DeepSeek AI tools

THE GUARDIAN

The Defense Department ordered government agencies to stop using artificial-intelligence tools built by Chinese startup DeepSeek, warning their use "may result in the transfer of sensitive data" back to China. The order adds to a widening rift between Washington and Beijing over who controls AI technology and the data that flows through it.

Japan launches mission to bring home a piece of Mars's moon

ARS TECHNICA

Japan's space agency launched its Martian Moons eXploration probe, aiming to land on Phobos and collect samples for return to Earth. The mission's climax won't arrive until 2029, when the spacecraft attempts up to two landings on the small, misshapen moon.

MARKETS

INDEX	LAST	CHG
S&P 500	7,674.87	-0.21%
Dow Jones	52,227.37	+0.50%
Nasdaq	26,213.83	-0.82%
Russell 2000	2,731.36	+0.11%
VIX	18.65	+1.14%
10-yr yield	5.11	-0.58%
CRYPTO		
Bitcoin	$81,582	-0.73%
Ethereum	$2,393.74	-0.58%
STOCKS		
NVDA	$213.34	-1.73%
AAPL	$340.49	-0.71%
MSFT	$526.05	-1.40%
GOOGL	$342.01	-0.63%
AMZN	$260.94	-0.58%
META	$683.95	-3.05%
AVGO	$333.35	-0.37%
TSLA	$365.78	-0.62%
SPCX	$144.07	-2.63%
BRK-B	$537.64	+1.02%
TSM	$418.05	-0.52%

Wall Street diverged Tuesday: the Dow added 0.5% on strength in value and industrial names, while the Nasdaq slid 0.82% as megacap tech sold off, led by Meta's 3.05% drop and declines of more than 1% in Microsoft and Nvidia. The 10-year Treasury yield eased to 5.11% even as the VIX ticked up to 18.65, a split that suggests traders are still leaning on rate-cut bets while hedging against near-term volatility. Bitcoin and Ethereum each slipped under 1%, tracking the broader pullback in richly valued assets as money rotated out of the AI trade and into steadier names like Berkshire Hathaway, up 1.02%.

ON THIS DAY

In 1803, the U.S. Senate ratified the Louisiana Purchase treaty, roughly doubling the size of the United States overnight for about three cents an acre.

FROM THE FEEDS · FULL TEXT IN SECTION B

AEON
How intuitions work — argues that a gut sense something's off works like perception, giving you reason to act before you can explain why.

LONGREADS
Death by a Thousand Dams — tens of thousands of small, forgotten barriers are blocking fish recovery across the northeastern U.S.

LONGREADS
Feeding the Revolution — traces the burrito's surprising history as a symbol of resistance.

NAUTILUS
Longevity Research Has a Bullshit Problem — impossible ages and invented biographies keep slipping into the science of aging.

NAUTILUS
Astronomers Find First Green Star — a genuinely green star would be a first for astronomy, and this one might qualify.

PSYCHE
How to Overcome Task Paralysis — goal-management training can help the stuck, stressed, or ADHD-addled get moving again.

QUANTA
AI Proved the Quasi-Riemann Hypothesis — an AI-generated proof of a major number-theory result has mathematicians recalculating what comes next.

TRICYCLE
Open Heart, Ungrasping Heart — a longtime Buddhist teacher on the freedom that comes from meeting life without reflexive judgment.

Generated 2026-10-20 by Claude

Sources: RSS, Open-Meteo, Yahoo Finance, CoinGecko, web

QUANTA MAGAZINE

AI Proved the Quasi-Riemann Hypothesis. What Happens Now?

KONSTANTIN KAKAES OCTOBER · QUANTAMAGAZINE.ORG · OCT 19, 2026

A rare AI-generated proof that human mathematicians have actually verified, with big implications.

Among the 377 results that OpenAI announced on October 6, 2026, one stood out. It claimed to settle the "quasi-Riemann hypothesis" — a weaker version of the Riemann hypothesis, which is arguably the biggest open question in math. The new proof is, as Jared Duker Lichtman of Stanford University put it, "the most significant AI-for-math achievement so far, by quite a margin."

The Riemann hypothesis has been an open problem for over 160 years. Resolving it would enable mathematicians to better understand the nature of prime numbers, one of math's most crucial building blocks. And that's just for starters.

The implications of even the more limited "quasi-RH" result are "staggering," said Maksym Radziwiłł of New York University. "In a sense, the vast majority of consequences of RH already follow from quasi-RH."

Moreover, contrary to what mathematicians had long expected, the proof didn't need to introduce any new concepts — it instead unearthed hidden connections between old ones. "The proof is a surprising synthesis of well-known ideas," said Alexander Dunn of the Georgia Institute of Technology.

The result relied in part on techniques pioneered by Radziwiłł and Dunn. Alongside other number theorists, they have been working to understand the proof and what it could mean. Now they're starting to get answers.

To Zeta and Beyond

To understand what the quasi-Riemann hypothesis says, you first have to understand the Riemann hypothesis. When the Clay Mathematics Institute announced seven Millennium Prize Problems at the turn of the century, the Riemann hypothesis loomed above the other six. It was the only one carried over from the celebrated agenda-setting list of problems that David Hilbert had announced a century earlier.

Continued online (full article about 1646 words). Scan, or visit https://www.quantamagazine.org/ai-proved-the-quasi-riemann-hypothesis-what-happens-now-20261019/

NAUTILUS

Longevity Research Has a Bullshit Problem

SAUL JUSTIN NEWMAN · NAUTIL.US · OCT 19, 2026

A sharp look at how impossible ages and invented biographies become accepted science.

Debunking a case that is widely accepted by the scientific community is like seeing a piece of a movie set fall over: You realize in a moment that the saloon in the spaghetti western is not a two-story building but a painted two-dimensional prop made of plywood. You have the illusion of solidity in one moment, an incredulous feeling of having been tricked in the next, and after a stunned second you begin looking at the entire street thinking, "I bet that brothel's made of cardboard."

I had this feeling on a regular basis once I began investigating the world's oldest people.

Some cases required no effort at all. At one point, for example, the oldest woman in the United States was Adele Dunlap, a former smoker and occasional drinker. Adele kept insisting that the records had her age wrong. In a farcical, tragicomically weird end to her life, nobody believed her, and she was collectively rubbished for being unable to remember her real age. Despite consistently claiming for almost a decade that her paperwork was wrong, and that she was a decade younger than her documents suggested, Adele was duly informed by newspapers that she was mistaken about herself.

The academics knew better. A typical exchange ran thus: "Asked how it felt to be 113, Dunlap… looked her questioner in the eye and answered: 'I'm 104.'" The reporter shot her down: "She's not. The Los Angeles-based Gerontology Research Group [GRG], which tracks supercentenarians, or people 110 and older, has validated her age." Faced with a contradiction, Robert Young—director of the GRG, who certifies age records for the Guinness World Records—told this woman on her deathbed that she was wrong and that she was certified as the oldest woman in the country.

Continued online (full article about 1708 words). Scan, or visit https://nautil.us/longevity-research-has-a-bullshit-problem-1285933/

LONGREADS

Death by a Thousand Dams

CAROLYN WELLS · LONGREADS.COM · OCT 20, 2026

Deep reporting on the small barriers quietly strangling fish recovery in the Northeast.

Thousands of small, often obsolete dams are blocking fish migrations across the United States. In this piece, Ben Goldfarb explores the growing movement to remove these barriers—despite political, economic, and emotional obstacles. He asks, "Can government agencies and conservation groups pick up the pace of dam removal while fish are still around to benefit?"

The Eastern Seaboard's most enthusiastic purger of dams has long been Plymouth, Massachusetts, and one weekend I visited during its Herring Festival, a celebration of the resurgent alewife population that annually runs up Town Brook, the stream at Plymouth's heart. The day was cool and damp, and I followed a posse of dads in Red Sox sweatshirts and kids in rainboots up the path that paralleled the creek. Someone had chalked "LOOK FISH" on the asphalt, and I glanced streamward to find alewives holding in small pods, weaving around each other in their effortless way.

More fishy picks

"Furnace Brook in East Sussex was home to carp, tench, bream, roach and trout—and 15 trailer-loads had to be buried."

"Coming face to face with lionfish in the warming waters of the Aegean Sea, James Bridle traces the unfolding of geology, evolution, and empire that not only occasions this meeting, but binds us in relationship with this 'invasive' species."

Lauren Silverman weaves together issues surrounding relationships, immigration … and rainbow trout. It is a beautifully written, and highly personal, essay. Here's a fish that is born with multiple destinies. It can choose to stay in its native river forever, or swim hundreds of miles into the deep blue — and it makes this life-altering choice…

"Scientists use DNA to solve genetic puzzles in waters around the world. But in Crane Creek, the mystery got deeper."

Continued online (full article about 312 words). Scan, or visit https://longreads.com/2026/10/20/dams-fish-migration-america/

LONGREADS

Feeding the Revolution

CHERI LUCAS ROWLANDS · LONGREADS.COM · OCT 19, 2026

The burrito's unlikely history as a symbol of resistance.

"As a child, I thought of the burrito as something predictable, filling, and reliable. It would be years before I saw it as a source of political conviction; something that once split my family's loyalty between their hungry children and a revolutionary cause." In this essay at Orion, Victoria Blanco writes about her Abuelita, whose family had owned a burrería in downtown Juárez during the Mexican Revolution, and how she worked hard there through childhood, making burritos for Pancho Villa's troops—an army fighting for a better life for the next generation. "The food we ate was built for movement," she writes, "the same way we were." Blanco reflects on the burrito as a symbol resistance, the borderland, and belonging.

I found the unspoken parts of Abuelita's childhood when I was working in a university archive as a student, examining photographs no one in my family had ever seen. One image stopped me completely: a rooftop terrace at the Paso del Norte hotel, where well-dressed Americans held cocktails and binoculars, watching the war across the river as though it were a form of entertainment. On the other side of that same river—a river with two names, Río Bravo on one bank, Rio Grande on the other—men were falling from gunfire while children went without food so that revolutionaries could have the sustenance they needed to keep fighting. I sat with that photograph for a long time, thinking about my abuelita, a girl somewhere in that city while Americans sipped cocktails and watched her world from a hotel roof.